POURIA BUSINESS

EXCEL AUTOMATION

Smart Inventory & Sales Manager

User Guide

A complete Excel system for products, stock, purchases, sales, customers, suppliers, expenses and reporting — built with standard formulas, no macros and no external dependencies.

Pouria Business · Excel Automation
pouriabusines1@gmail.com · instagram.com/pouria_busines · t.me/pouria_busines

What is in this guide

This guide takes you from a fresh copy of the workbook to a working system with your own products and your first invoice. It takes about fifteen minutes to read and about the same to set up for a small catalogue.

Section	What it covers
1. Before you start	Excel requirements, file handling, what the colours mean
2. The ten sheets	What each sheet is for and who uses it
3. First-time setup	Business details, categories, your products
4. Daily use	Recording a purchase, an invoice, an expense
5. Reading the dashboard	What every KPI means and when to act on it
6. Reports	Monthly and annual performance, printing
7. Protecting your data	Backups, sheet protection, what not to edit
8. Troubleshooting	The six things that actually go wrong, and the fix
9. Starting clean	Removing the demo records before going live

1. Before you start

Requirements

Microsoft Excel 2016 or newer on Windows or macOS, or Microsoft 365. Excel for the web works but is slower on large ranges. LibreOffice Calc opens the file and most formulas calculate, but charts and conditional formatting do not always match Excel exactly, so Excel is the supported environment.

What the colours mean

Colour	Meaning	Can I type here?
White text on dark blue	An input cell — product names, quantities, prices	Yes
Grey text on navy	A formula cell — totals, stock levels, statuses	No (locked)
Green	A good result: in stock, paid, profitable	—
Amber	Something needs attention: low stock, part paid, balance due	—
Red	A problem: out of stock, unpaid and overdue	—

No password on protection
Every data sheet is protected so a formula cannot be overwritten by accident, but there is no password. To edit structure, go to **Review > Unprotect Sheet**.

Files in this product

File	Use it for
Pouria_Business_Inventory_Manager.xlsx	The real product, with a full year of demo data so you can see every feature working
Sample_Data.xlsx	Same workbook, all records empty — start your live business here
User_Guide.pdf	This document

2. The ten sheets

The navigation strip at the top of every sheet links to all ten. The three sheets at the end (SalesData, PurchaseData, Lists) are hidden on purpose and are explained in section 7.

Sheet	What it does	Who uses it
Dashboard	Twelve KPIs, a monthly sales chart, top products, recent invoices and a reorder list	Owner, manager
Products	Your catalogue: cost, selling price, minimum stock, live stock status	Owner, buying
Sales	One row per invoice: amounts, tax, profit and payment status calculate themselves	Sales, admin
Purchases	One row per delivery from a supplier; raises stock automatically	Buying, warehouse
Inventory	Live stock position with reorder quantities and out-of-stock flags	Warehouse
Customers	Customer database plus lifetime value and outstanding balance	Sales
Suppliers	Supplier database plus order count and total spend	Buying
Expenses	Operating costs by category and date	Owner, accounts
Reports	Month-by-month sales, profit and expenses; annual summary	Owner, accountant
Settings	Business name, currency, tax rate, and every dropdown list	Owner

How the sheets fit together

You only ever type on five sheets: Products, Sales, Purchases, Expenses and Customers/Suppliers. Everything else is calculated. A sale recorded on the Sales sheet immediately reduces stock on Products, changes the Inventory status, appears in the Dashboard KPIs and lands in the monthly Reports table. You never update the same figure twice.

3. First-time setup

Step 1 — business details

Open **Settings** and fill in the business profile block: business name, currency code and symbol, tax rate, fiscal year start and low-stock default. The tax rate is a percentage (9% is entered as **0.09**) and is used by every invoice, purchase order and expense.

Step 2 — categories

The category list in Settings feeds the dropdown on the Products sheet and the “Sales by category” table in Reports. Add or rename categories there, never by typing a new category directly into the Products sheet — a typo creates a second, separate category in your reports.

Step 3 — your products

On **Products**, each row is one product. The first nine columns are yours to fill:

Column	What to enter	Example
Product ID	A short unique code — never reuse one	PRD-001
Product Name	What you call it on an invoice	A5 Dotted Notebook — Charcoal
Category	Pick from the dropdown built from Settings	Notebooks
SKU	Your own stock-keeping code, if you have one	NB-A5-CHR
Supplier	Pick the supplier ID from the dropdown	SUP-002 — Baltic Print & Pack
Cost Price	What you pay per unit	4.20
Selling Price	What you charge per unit, before discount	7.80
Min Stock	Reorder point — the level that triggers an alert	120
Opening Stock	How many you hold on day one	400

The remaining five columns — Purchased, Sold, Current Stock, Stock Value and Stock Status — are formulas. Do not type in them.

4. Daily use

Recording a purchase (a delivery arrives)

Go to **Purchases**. Enter the PO number, the date and the supplier ID. The sheet adds up everything that has that PO number in the purchase lines. To add the individual products, use the hidden PurchaseData sheet (Unprotect Sheet first, add one row per product: date, product ID, supplier, PO number, quantity, unit cost). Stock on Products rises immediately.

Recording a sale (an invoice is issued)

Go to **Sales**. Enter the invoice number, date and customer ID. The visible sheet then calculates items, subtotal, tax, invoice total, amount paid, balance, payment status, due date, days overdue, profit and margin. The sale lines themselves live on the hidden SalesData sheet, one row per product sold.

Why there are hidden data sheets
An invoice with four products is one row on the Sales sheet but four rows of quantities. Keeping the quantities on a separate line sheet is how real accounting systems work: the invoice stays readable while the detail stays complete. The visible amounts are SUMIFs over those lines, so the two can never disagree.

Recording an expense

Use **Expenses**: date, category (dropdown), description, who you paid, and the amount before tax. Tax and total calculate automatically. Expenses reduce net profit but never touch stock.

Adding a customer or supplier

Add them on Customers or Suppliers **first**, then pick the ID from the dropdown on Sales or Purchases. The dropdowns read the ID column, so a new customer appears in the list as soon as the row is filled in.

5. Reading the dashboard

Twelve KPI cards in three bands, then a monthly sales chart, your five best products, the eight most recent invoices and a live reorder list. Every figure recalculates when you open the file.

KPI	What it tells you	Act when
Total sales	Value of all invoices, excluding tax	—
Gross profit	Sales minus the cost of what you sold	Margin falls below ~30%
Net profit	Gross profit minus operating expenses	It goes negative
Purchases	Total spend with suppliers	It outruns sales for 2+ months
Expenses	All operating costs recorded	A category creeps up
Inventory value	Stock on hand at cost price	It balloons — cash is sitting on shelves
Products	Active SKUs in the catalogue	—
Low stock	Products at or below minimum level	Every day — reorder these
Out of stock	Products with nothing left to sell	Today, or you lose the sale
Receivables	Invoiced but not yet paid	It exceeds one month of sales
Invoices	Number of sales documents issued	—
Average invoice	Mean value per invoice	It drifts down — check discounting

The **Reorder now** list is the one column to check before you order anything: it ranks products by how far below twice their minimum level they are, and shows the quantity that would bring them back up.

6. Reports

The Reports sheet has no inputs. It builds three things: a month-by-month table (invoices, sales, cost of goods, gross profit, expenses), a chart comparing sales and gross profit across the year, and an annual summary with the figures your accountant will ask for. Everything is print-ready: File > Print, landscape, fitted to one page wide.

Month boundaries

Months are read from the date column, so an invoice dated 31 August belongs to August regardless of when you typed it. If a month shows zero sales, check the date column on the line sheet — a date stored as text is the usual cause.

7. Protecting your data

Backups

Keep the workbook in OneDrive or a folder your backup tool covers, and take a copy at month end named with the period (for example **Inventory_2026-08.xlsx**). If something goes badly wrong, restoring last month's copy costs you a month of typing; not having one costs you the history.

What not to edit

Do not delete rows on the hidden SalesData or PurchaseData sheets without deleting the matching invoice — the visible totals are SUMIFs over those rows, so an orphan line will show up as revenue that belongs to no invoice. Do not rename sheets: the formulas reference them by name. Do not insert columns in the middle of a data sheet; add to the right-hand end.

Changing a price

Editing a selling price on Products does not rewrite history. Existing sale lines keep the price they were sold at, so last year's profit stays accurate and this year's uses the new price. That is deliberate.

8. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause and fix
A new product shows zero stock	No opening stock and no purchase lines yet. Enter Opening Stock, or record the delivery on Purchase
Sales total is lower than expected	Invoice lines are missing for that invoice number. Check the invoice number on SalesData matches ex
Every figure shows #NAME?	Usually a renamed sheet or a pasted-over named range (TaxRate). Restore from your last backup.
Stock is negative	A sale was recorded for more units than you hold. The system caps sales during data entry but a mar
A month shows no sales	The date is stored as text, not a real date. Re-enter it, or use Data > Text to Columns with Date for
Margin looks wrong on one invoice	The line's unit cost was changed after the sale. Unit Cost on SalesData should hold the cost at the tim
Dropdown is empty	The list it reads from is on Settings (or the Customers/Suppliers ID column) and has been cleared.

9. Starting clean

Open **Sample_Data.xlsx** rather than the demo workbook. It has the same ten sheets, the same formulas, the same dropdowns and the same dashboard wiring, but no records: no products, customers, suppliers, invoices or expenses. Fill in Settings, then Products, then your first purchase, and the dashboard starts working.

If you have already started in the demo file and want to keep your own records, delete the demo rows instead: filter Products by the PRD- prefix and delete those rows, then clear Sales rows 5 onwards and the SalesData/PurchaseData line sheets. Leave row 4 (the header) in place.

A note on the sample data
Every name, product, price and invoice in the demo workbook is invented for demonstration. There are no real customers, no real sales and no testimonials. Replace it with your own data before showing the workbook to anyone.

Support

Questions about setup, or a change that is not covered here: pouriabusines1@gmail.com · Instagram @pouria_busines · Telegram @pouria_busines.

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